

Dice Dreams: Product Analytics & Behavior Deep-Dive

An End-to-End Data Project: From Event Structure to Actionable Insights

Project Overview

This comprehensive project simulates the role of a Gaming Product Analyst. It explores the full data lifecycle of the social-casual title Dice Dreams, focusing on optimizing the player journey, deconstructing the core game loop, and identifying key levers for retention and monetization.

Core Focus Areas

- **Tracking Design:** Defining granular event properties and metadata for behavioral tracking.
- **Onboarding Optimization:** Funnel analysis of the First Time User Experience (FTUE).
- **Behavioral Analytics:** Analyzing the "Build & Raid" core loop through synthetic datasets.
- **Business Intelligence:** Visualizing KPIs to drive actionable product recommendations.

Technical Documentation

- **Full Event Dictionary:** [Google Sheets](#) | *A detailed breakdown of triggers and attributes.*
- **Interactive Dashboard:** [Looker](#) | *Live visualization of player trends.*
- **SQL Repository:** [GitHub](#) | *Queries for the BigQuery environment.*

Author & Contact

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Tools Used: SQL (BigQuery), Looker Studio, Google Sheets.

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Project Abstract & Product Overview

Selection Rationale & Business Context

As a passionate gamer aspiring to become an analyst in the gaming industry, I chose to analyze Dice Dreams due to its fast paced onboarding and high social engagement. My objective is to map and optimize User Journey, focusing on how players transition from initial install to long term active users.

This project focuses on Product Analytics rather than economy. By analyzing core growth metrics such as DAU, Installs and Retention, I aim to identify friction points within the user experience. By leveraging data driven insights, I aim to provide actionable recommendations for improving user engagement and funnel conversion.

Product Definition & Core Purpose

Dice Dreams is a mobile **"Social-Casual"** title centered around a Build & Raid loop. Players roll dice to earn coins, which are then invested in building and upgrading themed kingdoms. The core purpose is to provide a high engagement entertainment experience through social interactions, such as attacking a friends' kingdom or stealing their resources, creating a strong psychological incentive for daily login.

Business Model & Revenue Strategy

The application follows a **Freemium** model. While the core game is free to play (**F2P**), revenue is generated primarily by **In App Purchases (IAP)**. The monetization strategy targets "bottlenecks" in the gameplay loop, selling extra Dice Rolls and resource bundles for players who want to accelerate their progression, complete buildings faster or retaliate against competitors.

Target Audience & Market Positioning

The primary audience for Dice Dreams consists of "social-Casual" gamers, characterized by frequent, short burst gameplay sessions and a strong preference for social competition. I discovered the application through its high visibility in the Google Play Store charts, where it consistently ranks as a **Top 9 Grossing** game in the Casual category and remains among the **Top 50** titles across all gaming genres globally. This elite market positioning reflects its immense commercial success and the effectiveness of its long-term player retention strategies.

Onboarding Funnel & Conversion Analysis

The Strategic Role of Onboarding in Dice Dreams

In the "Social-Casual" market, the onboarding process is a primary filter for new player quality. While long term retention is driven by the "Build & Raid" loop and social mechanics, the tutorial serves as the initial conversion point within the user journey. An efficient onboarding experience is a vital indicator of a player's potential to transition into a long term active user. It ensures that players successfully reach the "Aha! Moment" where they first experience the core game loop. For product analytics and user acquisition (UA) purposes, tutorial completion is a high value early signal allowing us to identify high intent cohorts and detect immediate friction points before they escalate into churn.

Core Tutorial Objectives & Measurement

To ensure the effectiveness of the player's first experience, the analysis focuses on three key performance pillars:

- **Conversion Efficiency:** Tracking the percentage of players who successfully navigate the guided path to onboarding completion.
- **Friction & Barriers:** Identifying specific mechanical or technical hurdles that lead to drops between tutorial steps.
- **Time to Value:** Monitoring the duration of the onboarding process to ensure players reach the core gameplay experience the full "Roll,Build,Raid" cycle as quickly as possible.

Synthetic Dataset Structure & Data Schema

The quantitative phase of this project utilizes a synthetic dataset designed to mirror a production-grade tracking plan. The data captures granular behavioral signals through a structured schema:

- **Identity & Context:** Includes unique identifiers for users, sessions, and individual events, alongside application versions to allow for cross-version performance benchmarking.
- **Temporal Markers:** Each interaction is timestamped, enabling the calculation of time spent on individual steps and the total duration of the onboarding session.
- **Funnel & Progression:** The dataset tracks the journey through 9 defined stages, ranging from initial entry and profile creation to feature discovery, social account integration, and final completion.
- **Friction & Navigation:** Technical and user-driven errors are recorded by type, including the time required for the user to recover. It also captures the navigation path between steps and the specific point of exit for non-completers.
- **Outcome Indicators:** A logical flag confirms whether the process was successfully finished, serving as the primary metric for funnel conversion.

The Rationale for Tutorial Event Logging

In mobile gaming, the tutorial is the first high-friction environment a player encounters. To effectively optimize this experience, it is critical to implement a robust event logging strategy. Detailed logging allows analysts to transform a linear sequence of screens into a measurable funnel. By capturing specific behavioral signals at every milestone, we can pinpoint exactly where users struggle, identify technical bottlenecks, and measure the "velocity" of a player's journey toward the core game loop. Without granular event data, it is impossible to distinguish between a player who left due to a lack of interest and one who left due to a specific UI friction point.

Core Event Definition: tutorial_step_completed

To map the onboarding journey, I have defined the `tutorial_step_completed` event as the primary metric for progression. This event is triggered every time a player successfully navigates from one tutorial phase to the next.

The event holds the following key attributes derived from the synthetic dataset:

- **step_name (String):** The unique descriptive name of the milestone completed (e.g., `0_welcome_to_the_app`).
- **step_index (Integer):** The sequential position of the step in the tutorial flow, starting from 0.
- **time_spent (Float):** The duration in seconds taken to complete this specific step.
- **total_time (Float):** The cumulative time in seconds since the very start of the tutorial until this step was finished.

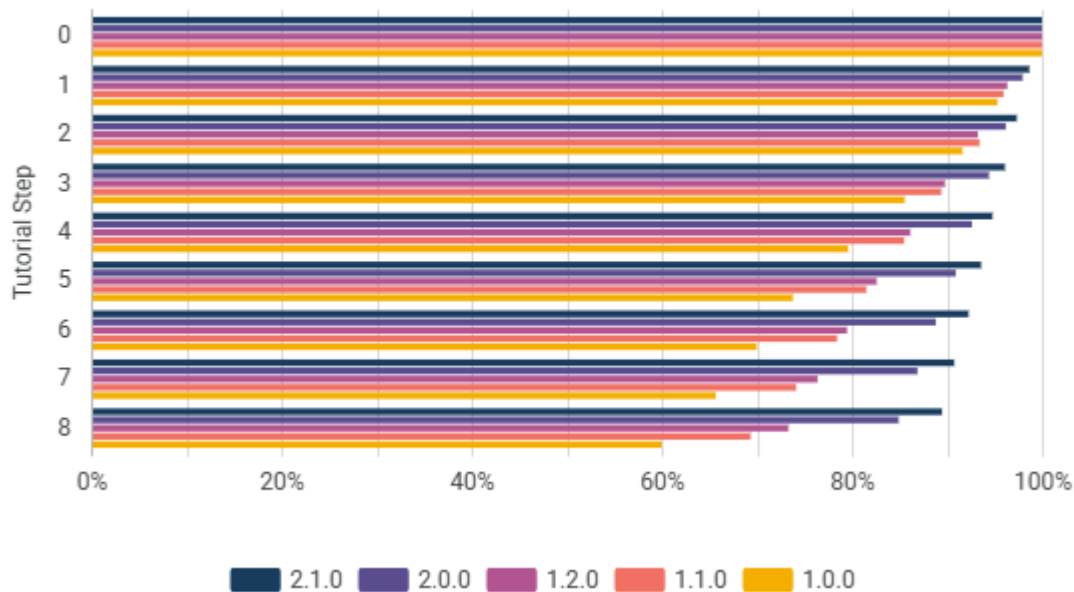
Data Entry Example from the Synthetic Table

Using a specific record from the dataset, we can see how a progression milestone is captured:

- **User ID:** `aed6e2f7`
- **Event ID:** `42b0c9dc`
- **Event Type:** `tutorial_step_completed`
- **App Version:** `2.0.0`
- **Tutorial ID:** `main_onboarding`
- **Step Index:** `0`
- **Time Spent on Step:** `16.426197705797794` seconds

Conversion Funnel Analysis:

I utilized a comparative bar chart to track user progression through the onboarding milestones. Unlike a standard funnel, this visualization allows for a direct side-by-side comparison between versions, making it easy to identify specific steps where "leaks" were resolved and where retention significantly improved in later iterations.



Tutorial Conversion: Key Insights & Trends

- **Optimization Success:** Analysis shows a clear upward trend in completion rates, moving from **60% (v1.0.0)** to a peak of **~90% (v2.1.0)**.
- **Friction Reduction:** Earlier versions (v1.0.x) suffered from high abandonment between **Steps 3-6**. Technical refinements in the latest versions successfully eliminated these "drop-off zones."
- **Performance Leap:** **Version 2.1.0** achieved a **50% relative increase** in efficiency, maintaining near-perfect retention throughout the funnel.
- **Business Impact:** The reduction in technical hurdles has significantly decreased "Time-to-Value," ensuring the vast majority of players successfully transition from onboarding to the core game environment.

To explore these trends and interact with the full dataset including version by version comparisons you are invited to [**view the interactive dashboard**](#).

Core Gameplay & Analytics Framework

The Role of Event Logging in Game Analysis

Event logging is the foundation for understanding how players actually interact with the game. By capturing specific user actions, we transform raw gameplay into data that allows us to measure engagement, identify friction points, and balance the game economy. Analyzing this data helps us calculate key metrics like conversion rates and retention. Ultimately, a well-defined tracking plan bridges the gap between seeing what happened and understanding why it happened, providing the insights needed to improve the player experience.

Top High-Impact Events

To monitor the overall health of the game and player journey, we track key events categorized by their functional impact:

I. Core Game Loop (Roll-Earn-Build)

- **Dice_Roll_Completed:** The primary engagement action; essential for balancing the game economy and tracking event progression (e.g., Magical Mission).
- **Attack_Finished:** Measures the outcome of competitive interactions, including blocks and bonuses.
- **Steal_Finished:** Tracks "Push-Your-Luck" success rates and coin distribution.
- **Raid_Finished:** Measures player performance in the obstacle course and the impact of Raid cards.
- **Kingdom_Building_Finished:** The primary indicator of player progression and the main "coin sink" in the economy.
- **Kingdom_Completed:** Tracks the completion of a full level, signaling long-term retention and milestone achievement.

II. Monetization & Conversion

- **Out_of_Rolls:** A critical friction point and the primary trigger for shop entries, ad rewards, or churn.
- **Shop_Entered:** Measures the intent to purchase and the effectiveness of store placement.
- **Purchase_Completed:** The ultimate KPI for revenue, tracking LTV (Lifetime Value) and conversion from free-to-play to paying users.

III. Social & Retention

- **Team_Help_Rolls_Given:** Tracks social cooperation and active participation within squads/teams.
- **Card_Send_Finished:** Measures the health of the trading ecosystem and social connectivity between players.

Event Definitions & Attributes

Below is a detailed definition of 7 key events, including the specific attributes derived from the Tracking Plan:

I. Dice_Roll_Completed

Trigger: once the dice land and the reward is calculated.

Attribute	Type	Description	Example
multiplier	Integer	The bet multiplier used for the roll (e.g., 1, 3, 5, 10).	10
reward_type	String	The core gameplay outcome (e.g., Attack, Steal, Raid, Coins).	Raid
mission_items_collected	Integer	Number of event tokens (e.g., Magical Wands) earned in this roll.	30
active_mission_id	String	Identifier for the current live-ops event.	magical_mission_04
secondary_reward_type	String	The meta-game reward being pursued (e.g., Puzzle_Pieces, Chef_Ingredients).	Puzzle_Pieces

II. Attack_Finished

Trigger: Triggered after the attack animation ends and the reward is shown.

Attribute	Type	Description	Example
outcome	String	Result of the attack (e.g., Success, Blocked).	Blocked
is_bullseye	Boolean	Whether the player hit the center target for a bonus.	true
Bullseye_Bonus	Float	The x2 bonus multiplier if the player hit the bullseye	2
card_level_bonus	Float	Multiplier based on the player's Attack Card level.	1.5
total_gold_gained	Integer	Final amount after all multipliers and bonuses.	150,000

III. Steal_Finished

Trigger: once the player stops rolling or hits a bomb in the Steal mini-game.

Attribute	Type	Description	Example
is_exploded	Boolean	Whether the player hit the bomb and lost part of the prize.	False
Total_Tries	Integer	The amount collected before bonuses	5
Base_Amount_Collected	Integer	The initial coins stolen before card bonuses.	450000
Card_Level_Bonus	Float	The bonus multiplier from the Steal Card level	1.2
Final_Amount_Stolen	Integer	Final coins added after bonuses	540000

IV. Raid_Finished

Trigger: once the raid obstacle course ends.

Attribute	Type	Description	Example
Total_Obstacles_Passed	Integer	How many obstacles were cleared	3
Is_GrandPrize_Reached	Boolean	<i>Did the player reach the end?</i>	False
Total_Raid_Coins	<i>Integer</i>	The sum of all coins earned during the raid	<i>1250000</i>

V. Kingdom_Completed

Trigger: once all buildings in a kingdom are finished

Attribute	Type	Description	Example
KingdomID	Integer	The index of the completed kingdom	5
Time_To_Finish	Integer	Total seconds spent on this kingdom.	86400

Rolls_Rewarded	Integer	Bonus rolls awarded for completing the kingdom.	30
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VI. Out_Of_Rolls

Trigger: Sent once the player's roll balance reaches zero.

Attribute	Type	Description	Example
LastMultiplier	Integer	The multiplier used just before running out of rolls.	5
Offer_Presented	String	The specific offer shown (e.g., Pack_Small, Ad).	Pack_Small
Interaction	String	The user's reaction to the offer (e.g., Clicked, Dismissed).	Clicked

VII. Purchase_Completed

Trigger: Sent after a successful In-App Purchase (IAP) transaction.

Attribute	Type	Description	Example
ProductID	String	The internal identifier used to track the specific item across all platforms.	pack_100_rolls
Price	Float	The transaction value as charged in the local store.	9.90
Currency	String	The local currency code	ILS
Payment_Provider	String	The platform processing the payment (Apple,Google)	Apple

Global Event Attributes (Super Properties)

The following attributes are included in every single event for cross-segmentation:

- **user_id:** Unique player identifier.
- **timestamp:** Exact time of the event (UTC).
- **app_version:** Current build version (e.g., 2.1.13).
- **platform:** Operating system (iOS/Android).
- **device_model:** Hardware used (e.g., Redmi Note 13 Pro).
- **country_code:** Geographic location.
- **player_level:** Current Kingdom level.
- **rolls_balance:** Current number of rolls at the time of the event.
- **coins_balance:** Current amount of coins at the time of the event.

Performance Metrics

Data-Driven Performance Monitoring

Establishing and monitoring a robust set of health metrics is essential for evaluating the game's operational success and long-term sustainability. By tracking these indicators, it is possible to differentiate between surface-level growth and true product-market fit. These metrics allow the product and data teams to identify friction points in the player journey, optimize the economic balance, and ensure that the cost of user acquisition is consistently offset by player lifetime value.

To provide a comprehensive view of the game's performance, the KPIs are categorized into three strategic pillars: **Retention & Ecosystem Health** (Staying), **Core Engagement & Gameplay Depth** (Playing), and **Monetization Efficiency** (Paying).

Key Metric Definitions

I. Retention & Ecosystem Health (Staying)

Focuses on the game's ability to maintain a stable and growing player base over time.

- **Retention Rate (D1, D7, D30)** Measures the percentage of players who return to the game after a specific number of days from their install date. It is the primary indicator of long-term engagement and product-market fit.

- **Formula:**

$$\frac{\text{Number of unique users who returned on Day } X}{\text{Total number of unique users who installed the app on Day 0}} \times 100$$

- **DAU (Daily Active Users)** The total number of unique players who engage with the game in a single 24-hour window. This measures the daily scale and vitality of the player base.
- **Stickiness (DAU/MAU Ratio)** Indicates how many of the monthly active players return to the game on a daily basis. High stickiness confirms that the core gameplay loop effectively retains users.

- **Formula:** $\frac{\text{Daily Active Users}}{\text{Monthly Active Users}}$

- **CPI (Cost Per Install)** The cost to acquire a single new player through marketing efforts. This is essential for determining the profitability of growth campaigns.

- **Formula:** $\frac{\text{Total marketing spend}}{\text{Total number of new installs}}$

II. Core Engagement & Gameplay Depth (Playing)

Analyzes how deeply players interact with the mechanics and social features of *Dice Dreams*.

- **Average Session Length** Measures the average duration of a single gameplay experience. This reflects how effectively the game's mechanics keep players occupied.

- **Formula:**

$$\frac{\text{Total cumulative duration of all sessions}}{\text{Total number of sessions}}$$

- **Feature Adoption Rate** Tracks how many players actively engage with specific social or progression features, such as team activities or card collection mechanics.

- **Formula:**

$$\frac{\text{Number of unique users who engaged with the feature}}{\text{Total Daily Active Users}}$$

III. Monetization Efficiency (Paying)

Evaluates the game's ability to convert engagement into sustainable revenue.

- **ARPU (Average Revenue Per User)** Measures the average revenue generated by every user, regardless of whether they have made a purchase or not.

- **Formula:**

$$\frac{\text{Total revenue generated within a period}}{\text{Total number of unique users within that same period}}$$

- **ARPPU (Average Revenue Per Paying User)** Focuses on the spending behavior of the paying segment, helping to evaluate the profitability of monetization offers.

- **Formula:**

$$\frac{\text{Total revenue generated within a period}}{\text{Number of unique users who made at least one purchase during that period}}$$

- **LTV (Lifetime Value)** The predicted total revenue a single player will generate throughout their entire Lifecycle in the game.

- **Formula:**

$$\text{Average Revenue Per User} \times \text{Average player lifespan in days}$$

Data Architecture & Strategic Storage Efficiency

To support scalable and cost-effective strategic analysis, a Summary Table methodology was implemented. This approach moves the analytical burden from the raw event stream to a structured, high-performance aggregation layer.

The Method: Multi-Dimensional Aggregation

Instead of querying raw event-level data (Fact Tables), which can contain millions of rows, we utilize an ETL (Extract, Transform, Load) process to materialize data into summary tables. This process translates "Atomic Events" into "Business Metrics" at the required level (User, Date, or Version).

Advantages & Disadvantages (Pros/Cons)

Feature	Pros (Advantages)	Cons (Disadvantages)
Analysis Speed	High Performance: Queries run in milliseconds, allowing analysts to perform rapid hypothesis testing and iterative data exploration.	Latency Issues: The data is typically batch-processed once a day, meaning it cannot support real-time monitoring or immediate tactical responses.
Operational Cost	Reduced Compute Costs: Aggregating millions of rows once in a batch saves significant budget compared to repeated full-table scans.	Extra Storage: Maintaining multiple layers of summary tables increases the total storage footprint within the data warehouse environment.
Logic Integrity	Unified Business Logic: Metrics like Retention and LTV are calculated once in the pipeline, ensuring that all stakeholders see the exact same "Single Source of Truth."	Fixed Schema: Any change in business logic or the addition of new metrics requires a full update of the ETL pipeline and reprocessing of all historical data.
Data Quality	Sanitized Outputs: The transformation layer filters out duplicates, handles missing values (NULLs), and ensures all parameters are correctly typed and normalized.	Loss of Granularity: By summarizing events into a "User-Day" grain, the ability to analyze exact micro-sequences or specific event timestamps is permanently lost.

The Pipeline Process: From Raw Events to Strategic Pillars

The data follows a structured three-stage pipeline to bridge the gap between raw logs and business insights:

1. **Ingestion & Flattening:** Raw event data is extracted from the fact table, and multi-value attributes are unnested into a structured format. During this stage, technical dimensions, device metadata, and transactional values are isolated, assigned appropriate data types, and prepared for the transformation layer.
2. **Strategic Pillar Categorization:**
The transformation layer organizes the flattened data into three core analytical pillars:
 - **Staying (Retention):** The pipeline establishes a baseline for each user by identifying their initial activation date. It then calculates the temporal distance (Day-N) for subsequent active days to construct a comprehensive retention matrix.
 - **Playing (Engagement):** Product-specific milestones and gameplay events are aggregated to measure the depth of player interaction, progression trends, and session frequency.
 - **Paying (Monetization):** Transactional data is normalized to a standard currency and aggregated into daily performance indicators and long-term cumulative revenue metrics (LTV).
3. **Materialization:** The enriched data is saved into a User-Day level table. This serves as the single source of truth for all strategic pillars, eliminating the need for expensive joins during analysis.

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Dashboard Architecture & Data Visualization

The Role of the Dashboard in Business Operations

The *Dice Dreams* analytics dashboard serves as the primary decision making hub for all stakeholders, merging complex data streams into actionable visual insights. By providing a single source of truth, the dashboard enables the team to monitor the game's "pulse" in real-time, identify emerging trends, and evaluate the impact of product changes. The architecture of the dashboard is designed to facilitate a top-down analysis—starting with high-level business health and drilling down into granular user behavior and long-term retention patterns.

Dashboard Interface Preview



View the [Interactive Dashboard](#)

Dashboard Layout & Components

The dashboard is meticulously organized into three specialized views, each serving a distinct analytical purpose in the player lifecycle.

Page 1: Gaming Performance Overview

This page provides a macro view of the game's commercial health and user growth, focusing on key performance indicators (KPIs) and market quality.

- **KPI Scorecard:** A top-level summary featuring cumulative performance for **Today's Revenue**, **Total Installs**, **Active Users**, and **Avg. ARPU**.
- **Daily Growth & Engagement Trends:**
 - **Total Installs:** A time-series chart monitoring acquisition volume to identify spikes from marketing campaigns.
 - **Daily Active Users (DAU):** A trend line tracking engagement patterns over time.
- **Market Quality & Revenue Distribution:**
 - **Geographic Acquisition Heatmap:** A global map visualizing revenue concentration and install volume by region.
 - **ARPU by Country:** A bar chart identifying high-value markets (e.g., KR, RU, BR) to guide regional optimization.

Page 2: Product & Monetization Deep-Dive

This view analyzes the game's internal economy and how players progress through "Villages" relative to their spending habits.

- **Village Economy & Scaling:**
 - **User Segment Distribution:** A bar chart breaking down player tiers (Minnow, Dolphin, Whale) across game stages.
 - **LTV vs. Current Village:** A scatter plot visualizing the correlation between a player's Lifetime Value (LTV) and their progression, helping identify "Whales" who advance rapidly.
- **Product Consumption & Stage Distribution:**
 - **Revenue Mix by Product:** A donut chart showing the share of revenue from **Spins**, **Coins**, **Access & VIP**, and **Offers**.
 - **Product Adoption per Game Stage:** A stacked bar chart visualizing which items are consumed at specific villages, pinpointing where players shift their spending from core gameplay (Spins) to utility (Coins).

Page 3: Player Retention Analysis

The final view focuses on product "stickiness" and the long-term loyalty of user cohorts.

- **User Retention Cohort Heatmap:** A specialized matrix tracking cohorts by their install date. It measures the percentage of returning users across critical intervals (Day 2, 7, 14, 28, and 60). The blue-to-grey gradient allows stakeholders to instantly spot the "cliff" where user drop-off occurs and assess the stability of the long-term player base.

User Interactivity & Data Filtering

To facilitate granular analysis, the dashboard is equipped with dynamic controls:

- **Date Range Selector:** Enables analysis of specific periods, such as holiday events or new version releases.
- **Country Filter:** Allows for deep-dives into specific regional performance (available on the Overview page).
- **Global Sync:** Filters applied to the top-level controls propagate through the relevant charts to ensure a consistent "single source of truth."

Strategic Dashboard Analysis & Actionable Insights

This section outlines the critical findings from the Dice Dreams analytical suite, followed by specific strategic recommendations to improve performance, retention, and monetization.

1. User Acquisition & Market Efficiency

- **Observation:** There is a dramatic drop in daily installs, falling from a steady average of 400 (Oct-Jan) to near-zero in the current month.
- **Analysis:** This suggests high competitor marketing activity or a lapse in our User Acquisition (UA) strategy.
- **Actionable Recommendation:** Conduct a competitor benchmarking analysis for UA campaigns. Immediately shift marketing budget to high-revenue/low-install "Quality Pockets" identified in the Map Chart. **Deprioritize the Japanese market** due to consistently low ARPU and prioritize high-conversion regions to maximize ROI.

2. Village 12 Progression & "The Economy Wall"

- **Observation:** A massive spike in "Coin Purchases" occurs at Village 11 & 12, but player progression almost completely halts immediately after.
- **Analysis:** Village 12 acts as a "Hard Gate" where the cost to progress exceeds player patience, leading to either a forced purchase or churn.
- **Actionable Recommendation: Re-balance the economy for Village 12.** We should lower the building upgrade costs or introduce a "Progress Booster" reward at the end of Village 11. This will smooth the difficulty curve and transition players into the more stable "Mid-Game" cohort rather than losing them at the first hurdle.

3. Early Engagement & D2 Retention Crisis

- **Observation:** Recent Day-2 (D2) retention is alarmingly low, with some cohorts dipping as low as 28.6%.
- **Analysis:** Players are not finding enough value or excitement within the first 24-48 hours to justify a second login.
- **Actionable Recommendation: Optimize the "Early Velocity" experience.** Introduce a "High-Reward Login Bonus" for Day 2 (e.g., massive spin bundles or rare cards). Additionally, simplify the progression in Villages 1-3 to ensure players reach the social "Team" features faster, which is a proven driver for long-term stickiness.

4. Churn Reversal & "Resurrected" Players

- **Observation:** The Retention Cohorts show "non-linear" patterns where retention percentages occasionally increase (players returning after being inactive).
- **Analysis:** There is a latent segment of players who are still interested in the game but need a trigger to return.
- **Actionable Recommendation: Scale the Re-engagement Engine.** Identify the specific push notifications or retargeting ads that brought these players back and automate them into a "Win-Back" campaign for all players who become inactive for more than 7 days.

5. Daily Activity (DAU) Stabilization

- **Observation:** DAU has been on a consistent downward trend for the past three months.
- **Analysis:** The lack of new installs combined with high early-game churn is hollowing out the active user base.
- **Actionable Recommendation: Implement "Live-Ops Daily Missions."** By introducing short-term, daily objectives with incremental rewards, we can create a stronger daily habit for the remaining user base while the UA team works on fixing the top-of-funnel acquisition.

Product Strategy & Feature Specification

The Evolution of Gameplay Mechanics

To maintain long-term player interest and drive sustainable growth, a game must evolve beyond its core loop. Continuous innovation is essential for shifting players from "passive luck" to "active strategy." By introducing new meta-layers, we increase the game's complexity for high-level players, providing them with new goals and meaningful ways to spend their resources.

Feature Proposal: "The Royal Architects"

1. Executive Summary

Currently, progression in *Dice Dreams* is linear: players earn coins to build and complete kingdoms. **"The Royal Architects"** introduces a specialized crew of experts that players can unlock and assign to their kingdoms. These architects provide passive bonuses to building costs, shield durability, and raid rewards, adding a layer of strategic decision-making to every roll.

2. The Problem & Solution

- **Problem:** Late-game players often face "progression fatigue," where building costs become extremely high, and the gameplay feels repetitive.
- **Solution:** Architects allow players to specialize their gameplay. If a player wants to progress faster through kingdoms, they hire the *Master Builder*. If they want to protect their progress from attacks, they hire the *Royal Guard*.

3. User Story

"Player Sarah logs in and receives a 'Blueprint' found during a successful attack. She uses the blueprint to recruit 'Leo the Master Builder.' The game informs her: 'Leo reduces all building costs by 15%!' Sarah assigns Leo to her current kingdom. Now, every coin she earns goes further, allowing her to finish the kingdom faster before her shields run out."

4. Core Mechanics

- **Architect Recruitment:** Players collect "Blueprints" from Raids or Chests.
- **Specializations:**
 - **The Master Builder:** Reduces building costs and upgrade times.
 - **The Royal Guard:** Increases the chance that a blocked attack won't consume a shield.
 - **The Treasure Hunter:** Adds a multiplier to coins stolen during Raids.
- **The Energy System (The Sink):** Architects need **"Inspiration"** (consumable) to remain active. Once their inspiration meter hits zero, their bonus disappears until fed with "Inspiration Sparks" found in-game or purchased.

5. Economy & Monetization

- **Primary Sink (Inspiration):** Players can purchase "Inspiration Bundles" to keep their best architects active during high-stakes events.
- **Secondary Sink (Blueprints):** High-tier blueprints are rare, encouraging players to purchase premium Chests.

6. Visuals & UI

- **Main Screen:** The active architect stands next to the Castle in the current kingdom (or next to the "Build" button).
- **Animation States:**
 - **Active:** The architect is seen working, examining blueprints, or cheering.
 - **Action:** When a bonus is triggered (e.g., a cheaper building), the architect performs a "Success" animation with a gold glow.
 - **Exhausted:** The architect sits down or falls asleep. Tapping them opens the "Feed Inspiration" popup.
- **Architect Menu:** A new tab in the collection menu showing all unlocked specialists and their current levels.

7. Predicted KPI Impact

Metric	Prediction	Reasoning
ARPU	 +12%	Purchase of "Inspiration" and Blueprint Chests.
Session Length	 +8%	Strategic management of architects and energy levels.
D30 Retention	 +6%	Long-term progression goals through architect leveling.

AB Testing & Statistical Analysis

Here is an abstract summary for an A/B test on the new "Royal Architects" feature for Dice Dreams.

Experiment Abstract: "Royal Architects" Rollout

1. Objective & Hypothesis

The primary objective of this experiment is to improve D7 Retention and Average Revenue Per User (ARPU) for mid-to-late game players (Kingdom 15+).

- **Hypothesis:** We believe that introducing the "Architect" mechanic will provide players with a sense of strategy and agency. By allowing players to optimize their building costs and resource management, we will increase daily engagement (re-visiting to manage energy) and drive monetization through "Inspiration" purchases.

2. Methodology (The Split)

We will perform a randomized **50/50** split on all users who reach Kingdom 15 during the 14-day test period.

- **Group A (Control):** Users continue playing the standard version of the game without the Architect system.
- **Group B (Variant):** Upon reaching Kingdom 15, these users unlock the "Blueprint" tutorial and receive their first Architect (Leo the Master Builder). They gain access to the Architect UI and the "Inspiration" energy mechanic.

3. Key Performance Indicators (KPIs)

- **Primary Metric: D7 Retention** (Target: Increase from 14% to 16%).
- **Secondary Metric: ARPU** (Target: Increase due to Inspiration Spark purchases).
- **Guardrail Metric: Progression Speed** (Ensure that building cost reductions do not exhaust content too quickly, leading to long-term churn).

4. Duration & Sample Size

- **Duration:** 14 Days.
- **Sample Size:** Minimum 12,000 users per group.

AB Test - Statistics & Results

The Results

- **Group A (Control):** 14.2% Retention Rate.
- **Group B (Variant):** 15.8% Retention Rate.
- **Difference:** Group B performed +1.6% better in absolute terms (a relative lift of ~11.2%).

Statistical Significance (Z-Test)

- **P-Value:** 0.00006 ($P < 0.001\%$)
- **Z-Score:** 4.02
- **Significance Level (α):** 0.05 (5%)

Conclusion: Statistically Significant

Since the p-value (0.00006) is significantly lower than the significance level (0.05), and the Z-Score (4.02) is **well above** the critical value of 1.96, we **reject the null hypothesis**.

Statistical Significance & Insight

The observed 1.6% increase in D7 retention is statistically significant. There is a less than 0.01% probability that this improvement occurred due to random chance, confirming that "The Royal Architects" feature is a genuine driver of player retention.

Recommendation

1. **Full Rollout:** Proceed with rolling out the "Royal Architects" feature to 100% of the user base.
2. **Monitor Guardrails:** Closely track the "Kingdom Completion" speed over the next 30 days to ensure the economy remains balanced.